ACTIVEEDGE

Performance Sportswear — Built for the Planet

Business Case — Project Presentation | PRP372S

Lecturer: Prima Inderlal • Due Date: 1 April 2026

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GROUP SETUP & ROLES

Six members, one shared goal

Responsibilities were split based on each section of the assignment, matching tasks to individual strengths while keeping the workload balanced. Everyone reviewed each other's work throughout — a genuine team effort.

AF

Abdullahi Farah

Group Leader

Business Idea Development & Value Proposition

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Researcher

Market Research & Community Context

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Writer / Editor

5W Marketing Strategy & Problem Definition

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Designer

Document Design & Formatting

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Presenter

Validation Evidence & Survey Analysis

UL

Uzair Larney

Lead Presenter

Presentation Delivery & Closing Remarks

COMMUNITY CONTEXT

A growing wellness culture, still underserved

- Fitness-active South Africans, aged 18–35, in cities like Cape Town and Johannesburg
- More people joining gyms, running events, cycling clubs, and yoga studios than ever before
- International brands (Nike, Lululemon) dominate at price points most locals can't afford
- Cheaper local alternatives exist — but sacrifice quality or sustainability

THE GAP

Existing products rarely address both performance AND environmental impact at once.

Our target market: students, young professionals, and fitness enthusiasts who care about their health and their environmental footprint equally.

PROBLEM DEFINITION

The trade-off no South African brand has solved

No South African brand seriously combines performance, sustainability, and affordable pricing. Consumers must choose between an expensive premium import or budget gear that wears out quickly and harms the environment.

1 WHO IT AFFECTS

- Young fitness enthusiasts (18–35) on a budget
- Environmentally aware consumers
- Women — underserved in inclusive sizing
- Gym-goers, runners, yoga & outdoor athletes

2 HOW OFTEN

- Budget gear lasts only 6–12 months
- Recurs every purchase, multiple times a year
- Peaks in Oct/Nov (summer) and January
- Eco-conscious shoppers face guilt every time

3 WHY WORTH SOLVING

- Durable, performance gear at fair local prices
- Reduces textile waste via recycled materials
- Creates local, ethical manufacturing jobs
- Builds a globally competitive SA brand

VALIDATION EVIDENCE

Grounded in real market data

A Google Forms survey shared across Cape Town and Johannesburg collected responses from 30+ participants across 8 questions covering demographics, spending behaviour, pain points, environmental attitudes, and interest in a brand like ActiveEdge.

30+

Survey Respondents

91%

Would Buy ActiveEdge

81%

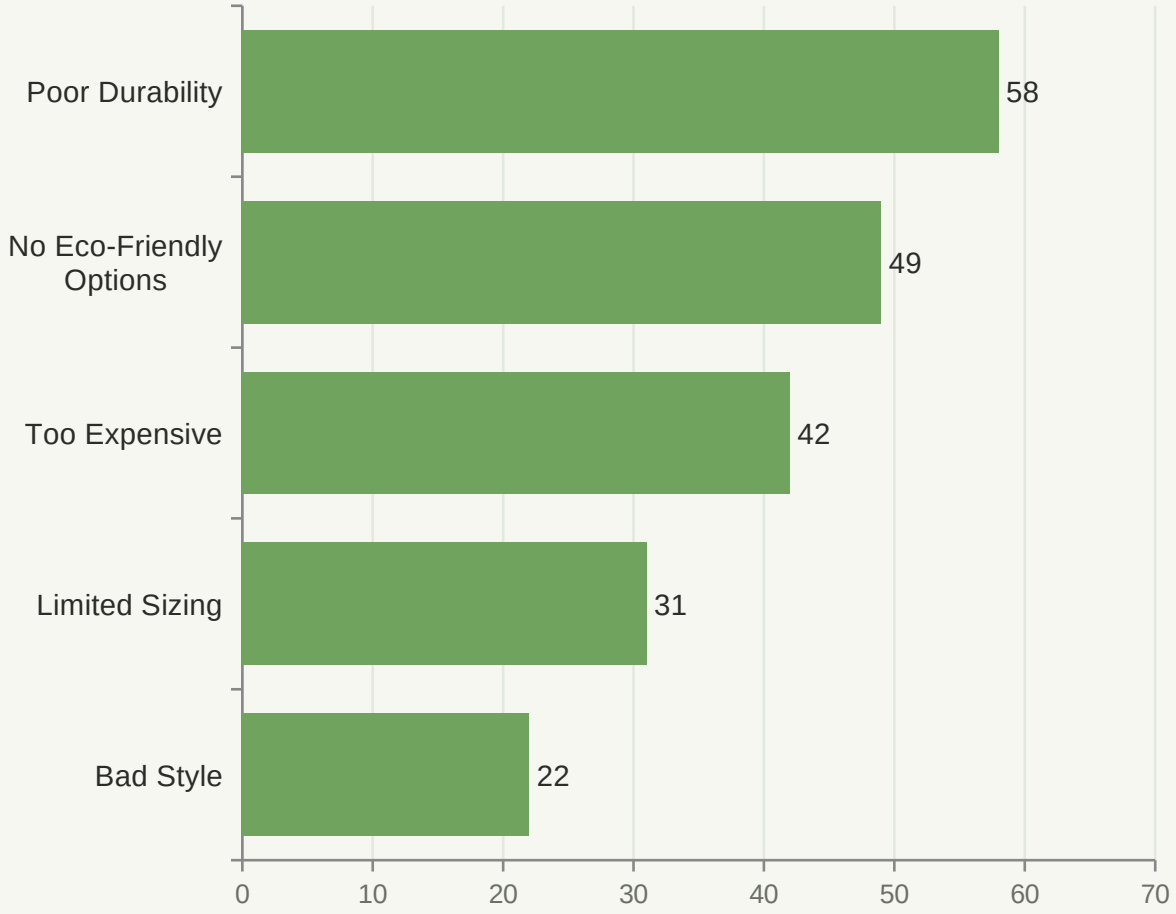
Prioritise Sustainability

Poor durability (58%) and lack of eco-friendly options (49%) emerged as the top two pain points — directly validating both the performance and sustainability angles of ActiveEdge.

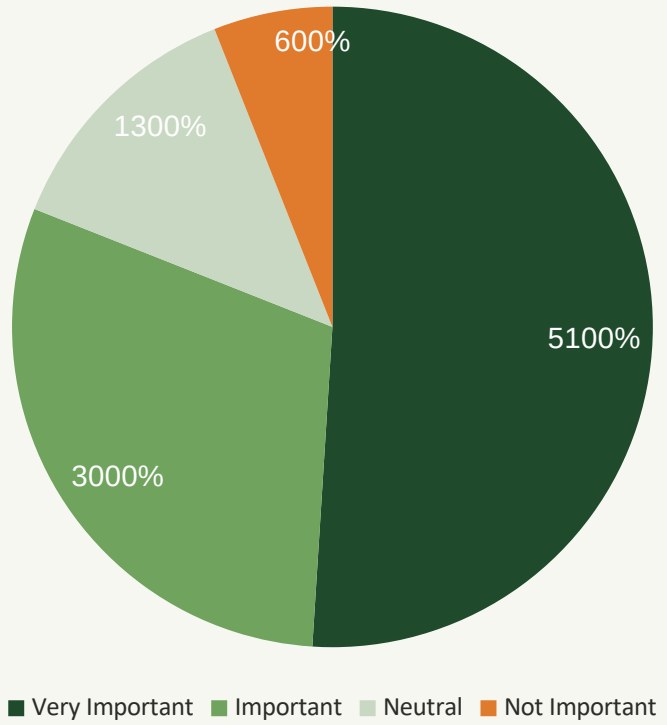
VALIDATION EVIDENCE

What frustrates buyers today

Biggest Sportswear Pain Points



Sustainability as a Purchasing Factor

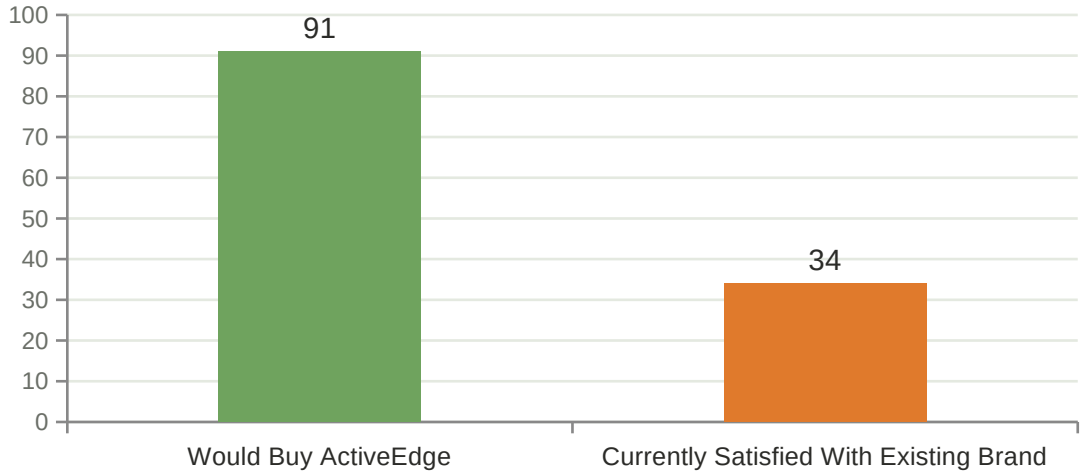


81% of respondents rate sustainability as "Important" or "Very Important" when purchasing clothing — the market already thinks this way.

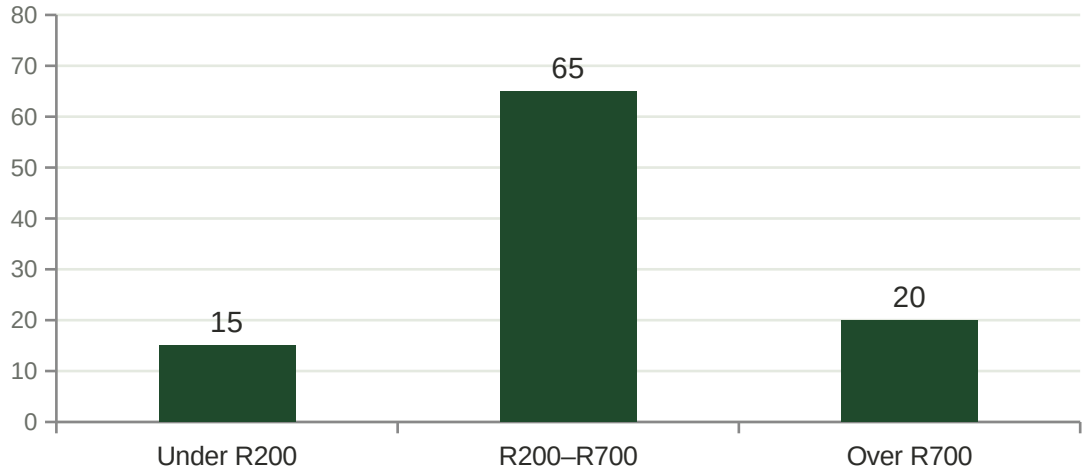
VALIDATION EVIDENCE

The opportunity gap

Purchase Intent vs. Brand Satisfaction



Current Spending Per Item



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Target demographic clearly represented — mostly young, fitness-active adults training 3x+ weekly
- Only 34% satisfied with current brands — real room for a differentiated new entrant
- Pricing sweet spot of R200–R700 matches ActiveEdge's planned range, lowering adoption barriers
- 91% purchase intent — an exceptionally strong signal the concept resonates with the market

PROPOSED BUSINESS SOLUTION

Positioned between premium and budget

ActiveEdge is a South African fitness apparel brand specialising in high-performance, environmentally friendly sportswear for men and women — without compromising on quality or sustainability. All products use recycled polyester, organic cotton blends, and certified sustainable materials, with plastic-free, fully recyclable packaging.

1

Leggings

High-waisted, four-way stretch, moisture-wicking

2

Sports Bras

Medium and high-impact support options

3

Tanks & Tees

Breathable, odour-resistant performance fabrics

4

Shorts

Training and running styles for men and women

5

Outerwear

Lightweight running jackets for variable SA weather

PROPOSED BUSINESS SOLUTION

How ActiveEdge solves the problem

Three pillars respond directly to what the research showed us:

1

Performance

Fabrics selected for the technical demands of high-intensity training — proper moisture management, stretch, and durability that outlasts conventional alternatives.

2

Sustainability

Recycled and eco-certified materials throughout, reducing textile waste and the environmental footprint of every garment.

3

Accessibility

Competitive local pricing (R250–R650 per item) removes the financial barrier keeping quality performance gear out of reach for most South Africans.

5W MARKETING STRATEGY

Five questions, one consistent strategy

Every campaign, channel, and messaging decision is grounded in a clear understanding of the customer and what drives their purchasing behaviour.

WHO	Target Customer	Fitness-active adults 18–35 who value performance and sustainability
WHAT	Product / Benefit	High-performance, eco-friendly sportswear from certified recycled materials
WHERE	Channel / Touchpoint	Online store, Instagram/TikTok, gyms, wellness stores, pop-up events
WHEN	Purchase Triggers	New Year resolutions, seasonal transitions, fitness milestones, Black Friday
WHY	Competitive Edge	Sustainability + style + performance at accessible local pricing

5W MARKETING STRATEGY

Who we reach, what they get, where we meet them

WHO

Fitness-active South Africans, 18–35, urban, training 3x+ a week. Performance-focused, sustainability-aware, and price-sensitive in a way international brands don't acknowledge. Secondary persona: gift buyers for birthdays or fitness milestones.

WHAT

More than gym clothes — customers invest in performance, sustainability, comfort, and identity. Products wick moisture, allow full freedom of movement, and hold their structure over months of intense use, backed by an ethical, authentically South African brand story.

WHERE

Online store as the primary direct-to-consumer channel with fast local delivery, Instagram and TikTok for organic content and influencer collabs, pop-up events and fitness expos in Cape Town and Johannesburg, and partnerships with independent gyms and wellness studios.

When they buy, why they choose us

WHEN — Purchase Triggers

January	New Year fitness resolutions drive the year's highest purchase volume
Oct / Nov	Start of summer and peak outdoor activity season in SA
Black Friday	Major opportunity for first-purchase discounts to new customers
Milestones	Completing a race, hitting a goal, or joining a gym prompts gear refreshes

WHY — Our Competitive Edge

No other local brand does all three at once: real performance, genuine sustainability, and pricing South Africans can actually afford — with no greenwashing, every claim measurable and certifiable.

- Recycled and eco-certified materials in every product — not marketing spin
- Inclusive sizing across a wider range than most local alternatives
- Pricing 30–50% below comparable international brands
- A South African brand story that genuinely resonates locally

VALUE PROPOSITION

ActiveEdge helps fitness-active South Africans aged 18–35 who are tired of choosing between quality, sustainability, and affordability, by offering locally designed, high-performance activewear made from recycled eco-certified materials — so they can train at their best, reduce their environmental impact, and feel genuinely good about every purchase.

WHO

Fitness-active South Africans, aged 18–35, who exercise regularly

PROBLEM

Existing sportswear is unaffordably premium, low-quality, or environmentally harmful — no local brand offers all three at once

SOLUTION

A South African activewear brand manufacturing high-performance sportswear from recycled, eco-certified materials at accessible price points

BENEFIT

Train better, reduce environmental impact, support local — without compromising on quality or breaking the bank

REFERENCES

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